Committee Elections April 2026

Anomaly Report

Election: Intersect Committee Elections, April 2026
Voting window: 20 April – 1 May 2026
Report date: 8 May 2026
Report By: Dquadrant Team

1. Executive summary

The audit examined **6,253 votes** cast by **347 distinct members** across **8 committee races**, scoring **102 candidates** in total.

Almost every vote satisfies the formal eligibility rule. **The structural anomalies, however, are pronounced and concentrated:**

- **12 of the 102 candidates** drew **>70% of their support from accounts whose first paid membership is less than 90 days old**. Several drew 95–98%.
- **10 voter blocs** were detected — groups of voters whose ballots are at least 95% identical. **8 of those blocs (covering ~83 voters) cast the bulk of their votes for the 12 flagged candidates** (between 69% and 100% of each bloc's votes go to flagged candidates).
- **126 individual voters score ≥50/100** on a sybil-fingerprint check (templated username, no profile content, only voter-tier badges, voted within days of signing up). The mean score for bloc voters is **40/100**, vs **26/100** for everyone else.
- A **dramatic spike in membership purchases** appears in the days immediately preceding the deadline which highlights 50–60 new memberships per day on Apr 6, 8, 12, 15, vs the long-term baseline of 1–5 per day.
- The 12 brigaded candidates include the **top vote-getter** in 6 of the 8 committees on raw counts.

These patterns individually pass the per-vote rule. Collectively they describe a **coordinated voting effort using accounts created shortly before the election**.

2. What we audited

For each of the 8 committee races we examined:

1. Every candidate's application (membership tier, application timestamp, identity verification).
2. Every cast vote (voter, candidate, time, both of the voter's most recent memberships).
3. Each voter's public Intersect profile, retrieved from the Members API at `/api/members/public-profile/{member_id}`.

Outputs are reproducible from raw data by re-running the pipeline produces identical results.

3. Techniques used

We applied four families of detection.

3.1 New-voter concentration

Question: *for each candidate, what fraction of their support came from members whose first paid membership is younger than 90 days?*

A normal candidate's support spans the membership distribution; a brigaded candidate's votes pile up on freshly minted accounts. We flagged any candidate where this fraction was ≥ 70% over a base of at least 10 votes.

3.2 Voter blocs (ballot-similarity clustering)

Question: *which groups of voters cast nearly identical ballots across multiple committees?*

For every pair of voters, we computed how much of their ballots overlapped (Jaccard similarity, 0 = nothing in common, 1 = identical). We connected any two voters whose ballots overlap by ≥ 95% and reported each connected group with at least 3 voters as a "bloc". A bloc represents people moving as a single voting unit.

3.3 Membership-lifecycle anomalies

Question: *did anyone deliberately renew a paid membership at the last minute to qualify to vote?*

We flagged voters whose previous paid membership had **lapsed before the deadline** *and* who **bought a new paid membership after the deadline**. This is the classic just-in-time renewal pattern — the voter satisfies the rule but only because their first-ever paid membership is old, not because their current one was active in time.

3.4 Sybil fingerprint

Question: *do these voters' Intersect profiles look like real people, or like accounts that were created just to vote?*

We check seven signals against each voter's profile and audit record, and combine them into a single 0–100 score. Low-effort accounts trigger the same signals: blank bio, no photo, only the badges automatically issued at signup, a templated or duplicated username, and a vote cast within days of signing up. A score ≥ 50/100 means several of these signals fired together.

Two signals were deliberately excluded because evidence shows they reflect normal member behavior, not a sybil pattern: *no committee participation* (most members don't sit on committees) and *no working-group membership* (most members are observers, not participants). Including them would inflate baseline scores for ordinary members and dilute the signal.

4. Parameters

Parameter	Value	Why
Validity rule	"current paid membership active at vote time" + (≥ 90 days as a paid member **or** ID-verified). Company members are exempt.	Codifies the published election rules. Permissive on purpose.
New-voter age threshold	90 days	Same number used in the eligibility rule.
New-voter share to flag a candidate	≥ 70% (min 10 votes)	Below this, organic candidates with disproportionately new fans start to appear; above this, the only realistic explanation is coordinated mobilization.
Vote-burst window	≥ 5 distinct voters in 60 s for the same candidate	Detects automated voting clusters.
Bloc similarity threshold	Jaccard ≥ 0.95	Captures coordinated groups while tolerating an occasional missed pick.
Minimum bloc size	3 voters	Pairs are noisy; 3 is the smallest defensible group.
High-suspicion sybil score	≥ 50 / 100	Three or more signals fired.

5. Findings in detail

5.1 Brigaded candidates (12 of 102)

Committee	Candidate	Total	New-voter share	Estimated organic
Cardano Budget (CBC)	Candidate 4	171	94%	~21
Cardano Civics (CCC)	Candidate 4	169	96%	~19
Cardano Budget (CBC)	Candidate 12	161	98%	~11
Membership & Community (MCC)	Candidate 1	162	97%	~12
Membership & Community (MCC)	Candidate 9	143	97%	~8
Membership & Community (MCC)	Candidate 13	158	96%	~13
Growth & Marketing (GMC)	Candidate 13	169	95%	~19
Growth & Marketing (GMC)	Candidate 14	167	93%	~17
Cardano Product (CPC)	Candidate 1	167	95%	~22
Intersect Steering (ISC)	Candidate 7	175	91%	~25
Cardano Civics (CCC)	Candidate 1	22	91%	~18 (borderline)
Cardano Product (CPC)	Candidate 9	202	80%	~56 (also has Bloc 2 organic support)

On raw vote counts, candidates from this list are leading 6 of the 8 committees.

For comparison, on the seasoned-voter slate (the 21-voter Bloc 2 voted for these), the top candidates have new-voter shares in the 5–25% range — i.e. their support overwhelmingly came from members with long-standing paid memberships.

5.2 Coordinated voter blocs

Bloc	Size	Total votes	Votes to flagged candidates	Share	Avg sybil score
1	**52**	780	**572**	**73%**	**45.5 / 100**
2	21	777	21	3%	16.9 / 100
3	7	84	77	**92%**	45.4
4	6	60	**60**	**100%**	44.7
5	4	48	**48**	**100%**	50.0
6	4	36	**36**	**100%**	50.0
7	4	44	**44**	**100%**	50.0
8	3	39	27	**69%**	50.0
9	3	39	33	**85%**	44.7
10	3	9	0	0%	16.0

Two qualitatively different cases here:

- **Blocs 1, 3–9 (83 voters):** all vote heavily for flagged candidates (69–100%) and all carry sybil scores in the 45–50 range. These are the brigading cells.

- **Bloc 2 (21 voters) and Bloc 10 (3 voters):** vote in lockstep for *non-flagged* candidates and have low sybil scores (16–17). These are organized but unsuspicious — a legitimate slate of seasoned members voting together.

The audit therefore distinguishes coordinated brigading from coordinated legitimate voting, an important distinction that raw "block-voting" detectors don't make.

5.3 Sybil fingerprint

- **Bloc voters score on average 40/100; non-bloc voters average 26/100.** A 14-point gap on a 100-point scale is a strong population-level signal.
- **126 voters** clear the ≥50 threshold. **37 of those 126 are inside Bloc 1 alone** (out of 52 Bloc 1 members).
- **The single biggest signal differentiator is "voted within 30 days of signup":** roughly 70% of bloc voters fired this signal vs. 25% of non-bloc voters.
- **Username collisions** (two distinct member IDs sharing the same `intersect_username`):
  - Member `3` ↔ Member `5` — both registered similarly - but old and with community history..
  - Member `7167` ↔ Member `7202` — share a username; `7202` is in **Bloc 1**, `7167` is non-bloc but scores 82/100 on its own.

5.4 Membership purchase pattern

The daily count of new memberships across all distinct voters jumps from a baseline of 1–5/day (over the prior 12 months) to **50–60/day on Apr 6, 8, 12, 15** — the week before the deadline. The vast majority of these signups are concentrated in the same range of voter member IDs that populate Bloc 1.

5.5 Lapsed-then-renewed voters

Four voters bought a paid membership *after* the eligibility deadline despite having held a paid membership previously, all with multi-month gaps:

Voter	Old paid membership ended	New paid membership bought	Gap	Voted in

200	2025-08-30	2026-04-30	~8 months	1 committee
355	2025-06-13	2026-04-29	~10 months	6 committees
523	2026-01-02	2026-04-28	~4 months	8 committees
2522	2026-04-09	2026-04-30	~3 weeks	8 committees

Voters 523 and 2522 look like deliberate just-in-time renewals undertaken specifically to vote in this election.

5.6 Time-of-vote bursts

Zero windows met the threshold (≥ 5 distinct voters voting for the same candidate within any 60-second window). Coordinated voting in this dataset was paced — almost certainly deliberately, to defeat exactly this kind of detector.

6. Outcome implications

The 12 brigaded candidates include the leading vote-getter on raw counts in 6 of the 8 committees. **If raw vote totals were used to seat committees, the brigading effort would seat several candidates whose support is structurally non-organic.**

If, instead, committee seats were awarded on the strength of votes from voters with ≥ 90 days of seasoned membership (or who were ID-verified before the announcement), the picture changes substantially in the affected committees.

The audit pipeline produces an excel sheet report that breaks each candidate's count into "Valid", "Invalid", and "Total". The results report is shared separately with the Intersect Team.

Appendix A: Supporting Analysis Graphs

1. 3D Network graph based on Jaccardian Similarity

Voters -> Candidates

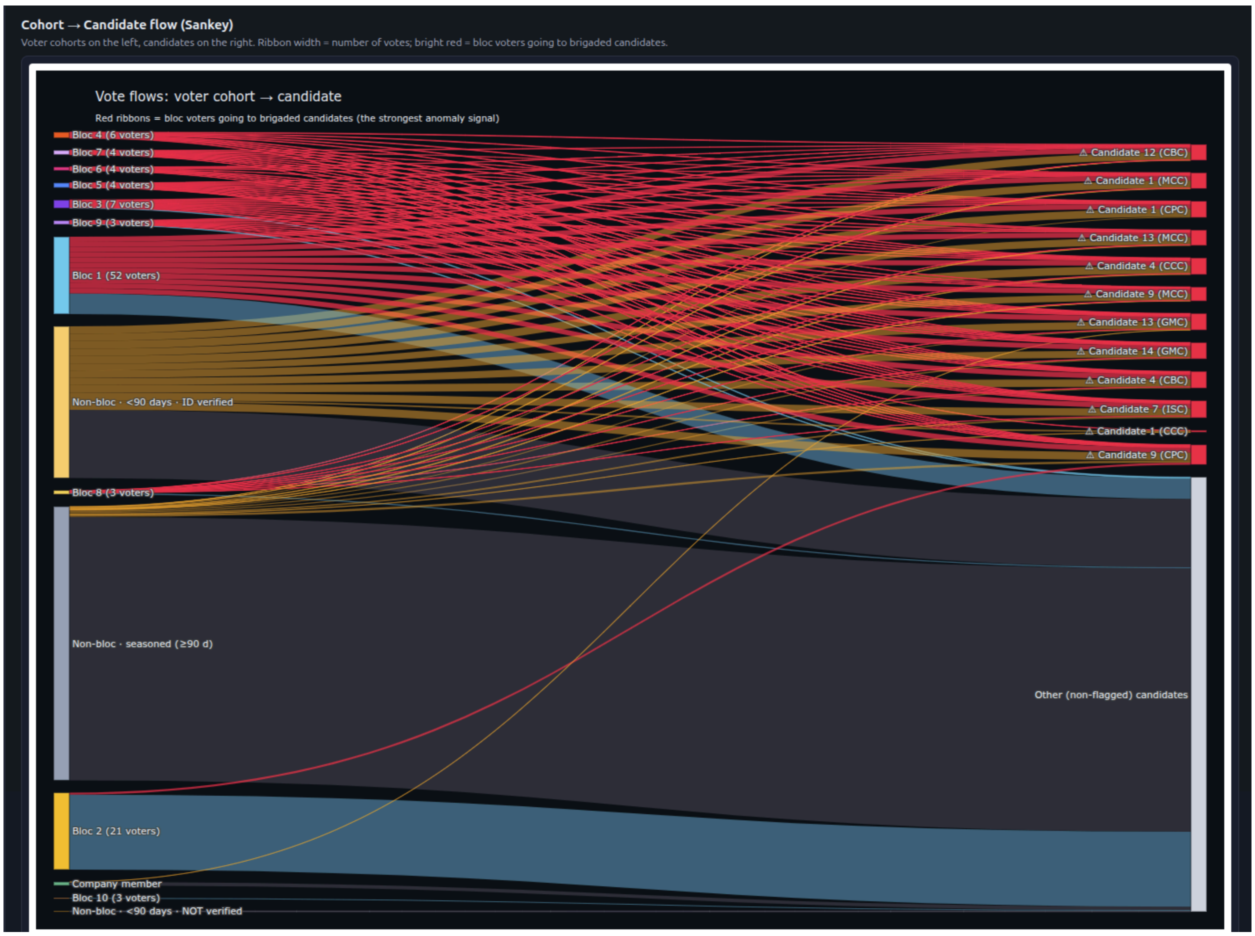
6,253 votes from 347 distinct voters across 8 committees.

12 candidates were flagged because more than 70% of their votes came from accounts whose first paid membership is less than 90 days old. 10 voter blocs (Jaccard ≥ 0.95) were detected — these are groups of voters who cast near-identical ballots.

Coordinated blocs cast 918 of their 1,916 votes for flagged candidates (48%). Bright red lines in the 3D view, and the topmost red ribbons in the Sankey, show this flow. When a single brigaded candidate receives most of their support from these accounts, the result on raw counts is artificial.

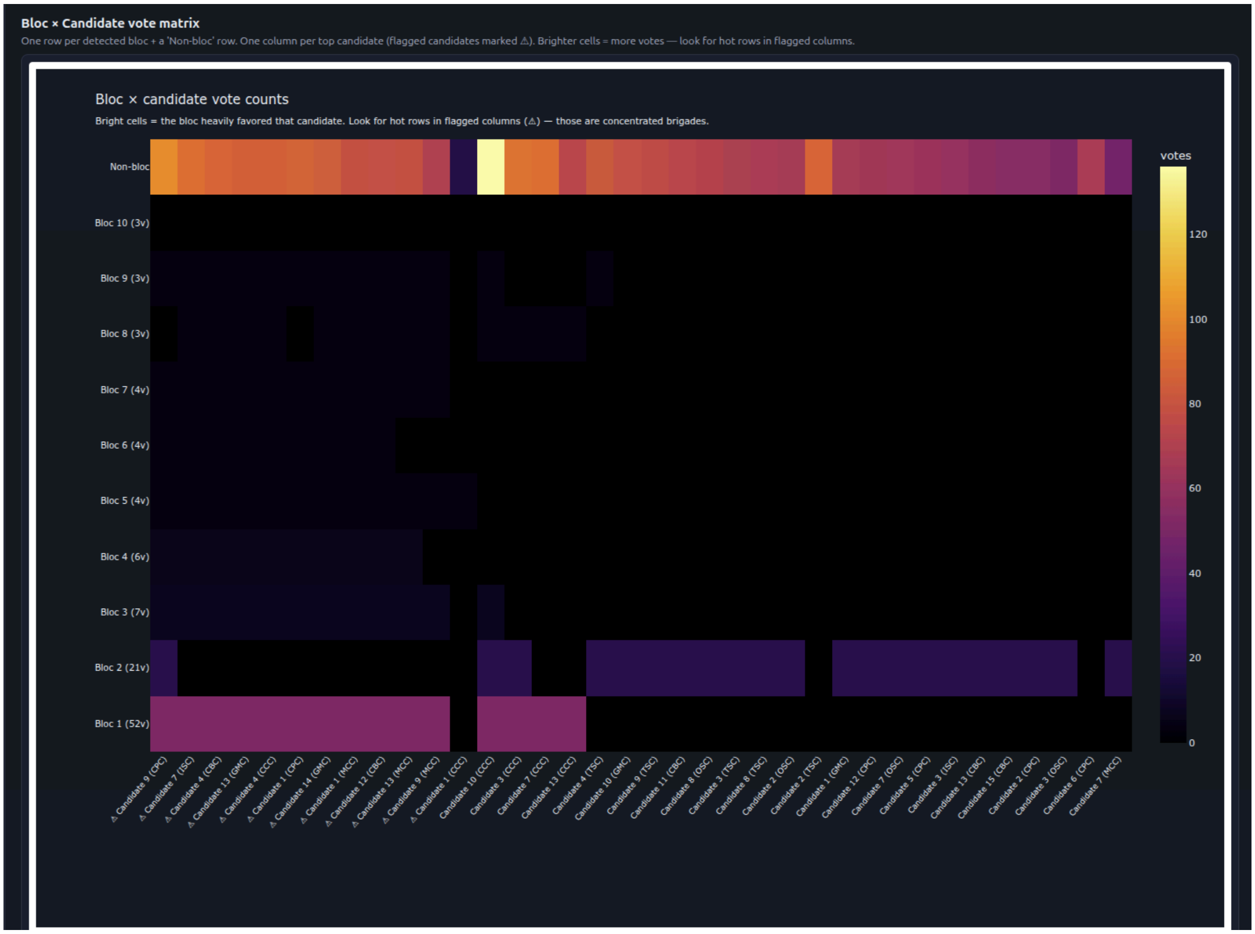
2. **Cohort Sankey**

Vote flows by Group



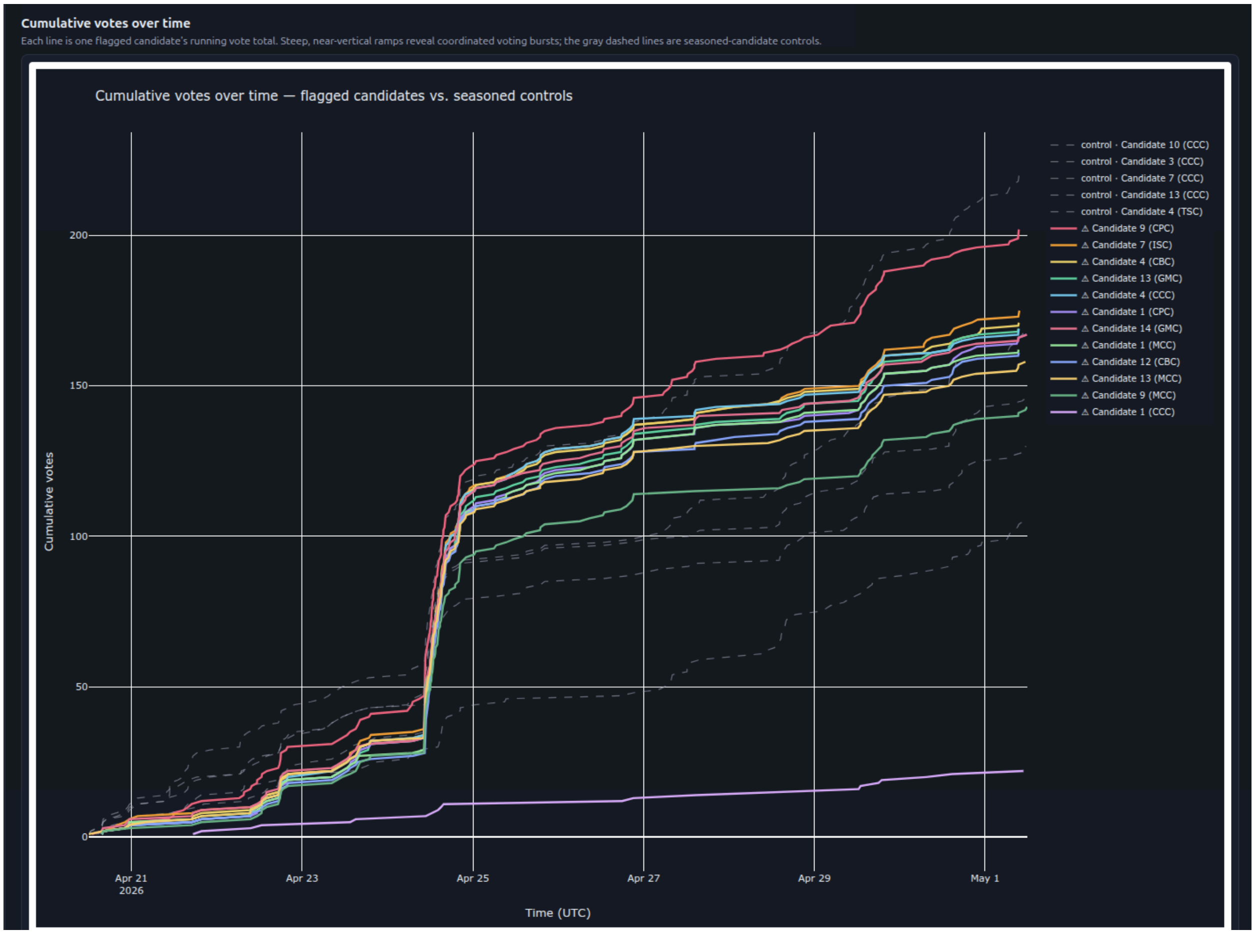
3. Bloc × Candidate

Who voted for whom?



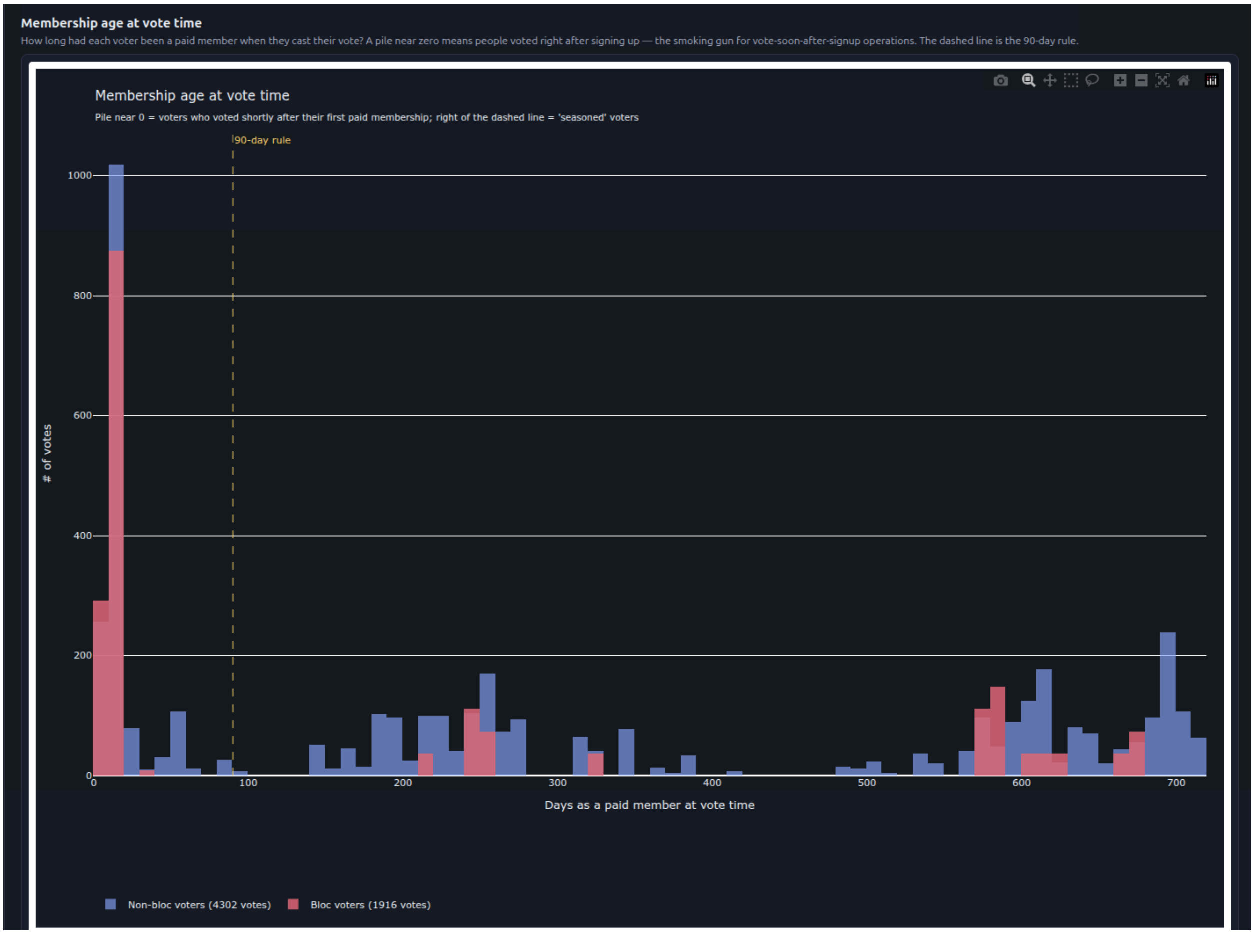
4. Vote Ramp

Cumulative votes over time



5. **Sign Up -> Vote Gap**

Membership age at vote



6. Sybil Score

Fake account fingerprint